

Church’s soul on the line ahead of conclave

Progressive-conservative divisions harden as vote for next pope nears

BY ANTHONY FAIOLA AND MICHELLE BOORSTEIN

VATICAN CITY — In their pre-conclave sessions in a sprawling Vatican auditorium, the assembly of cardinals is so large that members are wearing name tags. Some have delivered broadsides against the norm-challenging late pope in terms atypically sharp, while others say his successor should continue his mission.

As cardinals from Myanmar to Malta ready themselves for the largest papal conclave in history, battle lines are being drawn over the direction of the Catholic Church.

Pope Francis sought to drag the church out of the bedroom, de-emphasizing condemnation and embracing a motto of “todos, todos, todos” — everyone, everyone. But as they prepare to enter the Sistine Chapel on Wednesday, some cardinals now are pushing for sharper direction from a more hierarchical church that returns to doctrinal discipline.

In some ways, Francis left the church better off than he found it. The tumult over clerical abuse and financial corruption has dimmed since 2013, and the faith has continued to grow, albeit slowly, in most parts of the world. But the forces buffeting the church — secularism, the growth of evangelical churches — remain present even as new fault lines have opened, particularly between church traditionalists and reformists.

In closed-door morning group sessions and in private meetings, described in Vatican briefings and to The Washington Post in greater detail by seven people familiar with them, cardinals are outlining the challenges confronting the church in a time of

SEE CHURCH ON A21

A champion in the slop



LEANDRO LOZADA/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

With jockey Junior Alvarado aboard, Sovereignty roared past race favorite Journalism to win the Kentucky Derby on a sloppy track Saturday in Louisville. Alvarado prevailed at the Derby for the first time, and it was the second victory for trainer Bill Mott, whose first came following a disqualification back in 2019. **More in Sports, D1**

48-hour scramble to fly deportees to a megaprison

This article is by Sarah Blaskey, Samantha Schmidt, Silvia Foster-Frau, Ana Vanessa Herrero, Arelis R. Hernández, María Luisa Paül and Karen DeYoung

The message from Secretary of State Marco Rubio to El Salvador’s Foreign Ministry outlined an audacious plan: The United States would be sending as many as 500 Venezuelan gang members to the Central American nation, and it planned to do so within 24 hours.

The March 13 communication was part of secretive negotiations with Salvadoran President Nayib Bukele and served as Rubio’s for-

Venezuela agreed to take citizens, but U.S. pressed on with El Salvador plan

mal notice that the Trump administration was sending the Venezuelans to be imprisoned there for a year “or until a determination concerning their long-term disposition is made,” documents show. Detainees at the megaprison have no access to lawyers or contact with their families.

A Washington Post investigation shows how officials raced to

execute the plan, rounding up some of the men at their homes the same day Rubio’s message went out. And they pressed forward with the removals, even as Venezuela agreed to accept deportation flights, in a high-stakes bid to show power and deter migrants from attempting to cross the border illegally.

The Post examined immigration and court records, and conducted interviews with attorneys, friends and family members, to piece together information about more than 50 of the men believed to be imprisoned at the Terrorism Confinement Center, the megaprison often referred to by its

Spanish acronym, CECOT. The review shows that despite the administration’s claims, many of the immigrants sent to El Salvador had entered the United States legally and were actively complying with U.S. immigration rules.

At least two of the men imprisoned in El Salvador had been approved by the State Department to resettle as refugees in the U.S. after extensive vetting by federal law enforcement authorities, documents show. At least four had protections against removal

SEE EL SALVADOR ON A8

Children’s rights: Deportation blitz fuels fears of more separations. **A10**

Waltz’s fall began before chat gaffe

TALKS WITH ISRAEL ANGERED TRUMP

Adviser appeared to back military plan against Iran

This article is by Michael Birnbaum, John Hudson, Emily Davies, Sarah Ellison and Natalie Allison

President Donald Trump’s decision to oust his national security adviser, Michael Waltz, was the product of a slow accumulation of frustration with a former Green Beret officer who was seen as far more eager to use military force than his boss in the Oval Office.

Waltz’s fate was sealed by his inclusion of a journalist on a sensitive Signal group chat in March. But he had been clashing with other top officials since early in the administration, including over whether to pursue military action against Iran, senior officials and Trump advisers said Friday.

The episode has left some senior White House officials questioning the need for a traditional National Security Council and content to leave Secretary of State Marco Rubio, whom Trump on Thursday named as Waltz’s interim replacement, in a caretaker role for quite some time — a decision that will likely diminish an institution that has had a powerful role in shaping the foreign policy of modern presidencies. And it sidelines a key figure in the White House with a long track record of favoring military intervention, officials said. Trump has nominated Waltz to be

SEE WALTZ ON A6

The Sunday Take: Revulsion for Trump runs deep across Britain. **A2**

The Fact Checker: Trump’s Time interview: 32 lies, distortions. **A4**

Foreign policy: In 100 days, a total reshaping of the global order. **A18**

She live-streams 24/7. Is it life, or a performance of one?

A lonely young Texas woman has shared every second with strangers for 3 years and counting

BY DREW HARWELL IN AUSTIN

Six hundred and forty-two people are watching when Emily tugs off her sleep mask to begin day 1,137 of broadcasting every hour of her life.

They watch as she draws on eyeliner and opens an energy drink for breakfast. They watch as she slumps behind a desk littered with rainbow confetti, balancing her phone on the jumbo bottle of Advil she uses for persistent migraines. They watch as she shuffles into the bathroom, the only corner of her apartment not on camera. A viewer types: “where is emily?” It’s the only quiet moment she’ll get all day.

On the live-streaming service Twitch, one of the world’s most popular platforms, Emily is a legendary figure. For three years, she has ceaselessly broadcast her life — every birthday and holiday, every sickness and sleepless night, almost all of it alone.

Her commitment has made her a model for success in the new internet economy, where authenticity and endurance are highly prized. It’s also made her a good amount of money: \$5.99 a month from thousands of subscribers

SEE STREAMER ON A14



MANOO SIRIVELU/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Emily, with her shoulder-mounted camera, in Austin’s South Congress neighborhood in February. She is a model for success in a new internet economy, where authenticity and endurance are prized.

Warren Buffett to step down as Berkshire Hathaway CEO

BY TODD C. FRANKEL AND MAEGAN VAZQUEZ

Warren Buffett, still full of folksy wisdom and with that ever-present red can of Coca-Cola close at hand, said Saturday that he plans to step down later this year from his role leading Berkshire Hathaway, ending a run as an investment manager and CEO that was so stunningly successful for so long that it earned him the nickname “the Oracle of Omaha.”

Buffett, 94, built Berkshire Hathaway from a struggling maker of suit linings in the 1960s into one of the world’s most formidable economic enterprises with a \$1 trillion market cap — the first U.S. non-tech company to reach that milestone.

Along the way, Buffett earned a reputation for making shrewd, long-term investments in a wide range of mostly U.S. companies while extolling the virtues of patient and emotionless decision-making. Berkshire has held huge stakes in consumer icons such as Domino’s Pizza, Coca-Cola and Kraft Heinz to go with holdings in insurers, railways and oil companies. He and his partners mostly eschewed investing fads and cast skeptical



Buffett, the fifth-richest person, said he will keep his big stake and remain an informal presence.

eyes on corporate claims that sounded too good to be true.

Berkshire’s success transformed the company’s annual shareholders meetings, narrated by Buffett’s wide-ranging commentary, into popular events known as “Woodstock for capitalists,” attracting tens of thousands of investors to Omaha. His annual letters to shareholders were mined for nuggets of investing wisdom.

Near the end of Berkshire’s 60th annual meeting Saturday, Buffett revealed that he will recommend to the company’s board that longtime executive Greg Abel take over as CEO at the end of 2025.

Buffett has previously signaled that his successor would be Abel, who already oversees Berkshire’s Wall Street investments and has spent more than two decades at the company. The announcement’s timing was

SEE BUFFETT ON A16

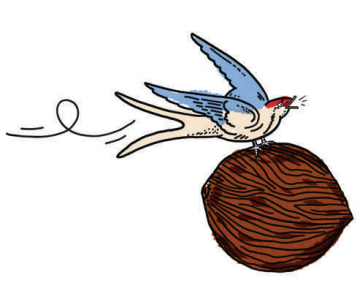
METRO
Trump will mark the Army’s birthday, and his, with a military parade.

BOOK WORLD
“Gandolfini” seeks to find the real man behind the beloved gangster.



THE WORLD
The Trump factor fuels a comeback for Australia’s center-left Labor Party.

BUSINESS
New fee sparks a tomato war between importers and Florida growers.



ARTS & STYLE
Much more than a flesh wound: “Holy Grail” turns 50, still hasn’t grown up.

TRAVEL
Get on the right track with this definitive guide to train etiquette.

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